

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)

500K

SMEs (within 2mo of waitlist)

1M

Social Followers (Roadmap)

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth

1 POSITIONING & OWNERSHIP SPLIT

POSITIONING PYRAMID (PRIORITY ORDER)

LICENSED FINANCIAL INSTITUTION

"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license" P0 LEAD

AI-NATIVE BANKING

"Open an account in 30 seconds — new generation banking" P1 DIFFERENTIATOR

ISLAMIC & SHARIAH-COMPLIANT

"Ethical banking as the added value layer" P2 CHERRY ON TOP

Global by Default: AI-native = global. First product = US (ACH/USD). Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). CBUAE does not care about global Mal activity. AAS = primary POC for Public Affairs.

MOAT GAP: "The only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." No unique claim text yet. Must be quantitative: "You just transferred money in 2 seconds. Will your other bank do this?" Study Brave's marketing approach.

OWNERSHIP MATRIX — WHO OWNS WHAT

BUDGET ALLOCATION

GROWTH — 80%

BRAND & MKTG — 20%

Budget holder: Amine | Growth strategist: Mukund (must develop budget request strategy)

DOMAIN	OWNER	SCOPE
Growth	Mukund / Growth	Userbase, economics, retention, referral program, acquisition (80% budget)
Marketing	Manar, Yasmeen, Isham	Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, content, sponsorships, TOV
Sales / SME	SME Team + Isham	SME onboarding (offline), CFO Summit, distribution partnerships, pipeline
Product	David, VK, Manar	Product demos, technical comms, launches. Manar schedules demos with leads
Public Affairs	AAS (primary POC)	Regulator relations, CBUAE comms (UAE-only). Disclaimer to regulators
Compliance	Maen + Walid	Risk, compliance positioning, regulatory readiness

Key Rule: Marketing does NOT own growth metrics, but every activity must CONTRIBUTE to growth (min 20%). Referral program owned by Growth (they own the economics). Sama handles hiring, Amine handles budget.

2 PRODUCT SUITE ROADMAP — 25 PRODUCTS

RETAIL — 14 PRODUCTS (INDIVIDUALS, EXPATS, BLUE-COLLAR)

BANKING — 6 PRODUCTS

PRODUCT	LAUNCH	MARKETS
USD Account — US-dollar account, 18 markets	Jul 2026	Pakistan, UAE, Egypt +
USD Payout — Local-currency payouts (Thunes)	Jul 2026	18 markets
USD Card — Rain card, Pakistan first	Jul 2026	Pakistan, UAE, Egypt
AED Account — Local dirham account (post-license)	Oct 2026	UAE
AED Payout — Domestic UAE transfers	Oct 2026	UAE
AED Card — UAE dirham debit card	Oct 2026	UAE

LENDING — 5 PRODUCTS (90% OF REVENUE)

PRODUCT	DEV	LAUNCH	MARKET
IVF Financing — Shariah-compliant fertility	Aug '26	Nov 2026	UAE
Tuition Financing — School/university fees	Sep '26	Dec 2026	UAE
Auto Financing — Car loans (Stitch / Mal)	Sep '26	Oct 2026	UAE
Personal Financing — Everyday needs	Sep '26	Oct 2026	UAE
Credit Card — Shariah-compliant	—	Nov 2026	UAE

FINTECH AI AGENTS — 3 PRODUCTS

PRODUCT	LAUNCH	MARKETS
PFM Agent — AI view of all your money	Jul 2026	18 markets
Travel Agent — Book flights/hotels via AI	2027	18 markets
Shopping Agent — Agentic shopping & checkout	2027	18 markets

SME — 11 PRODUCTS (BUSINESSES, 5-500 EMPLOYEES)

BANKING — 6 PRODUCTS

PRODUCT	LAUNCH	MARKETS
SME USD Account — Business account, minutes	Jul 2026	Pakistan, UAE, Egypt
SME USD Payout — Pay suppliers cross-border	Jul 2026	18 markets
SME USD Card — Corporate cards for team	Jul 2026	Pakistan, UAE
SME AED Account — Local dirham business acct	Oct 2026	UAE
SME AED Payout — Domestic UAE payments	Oct 2026	UAE
SME AED Card — Mastercard	Oct 2026	UAE

LENDING — 2 PRODUCTS

PRODUCT	DEV	LAUNCH	MARKET
Invoice Factoring — Unpaid invoices → working capital	Jul '26	Aug 2026	UAE
SME Financing — Credit lines & growth financing	Sep '26	Oct 2026	UAE

FINTECH AI AGENTS — 3 PRODUCTS

PRODUCT	LAUNCH	MARKETS
Tax Agent — Automated VAT & corporate tax	2027	UAE
CFO Agent — AI cash-flow & finance co-pilot	2027	UAE
Accounting Agent — Books & reconciliation on autopilot	2027	UAE

Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs only. EFG = lender, not a bank. Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop shop. Retail + SME.

Revenue Principle: ALL products revenue-generating (acquire → retain). 90% of revenue from lending/financing. "Pure flex" products for brand halo. Not ready to lend yet — building pipeline.

3 PHASED TIMELINE & LAUNCH SEQUENCE

MASTER TIMELINE

NOW — PHASE 1: PLUMBING

Test that the app works

Internal QA, stress testing, end-to-end flows. No external comms.

PHASE 2 — WAITLIST HYPE (PRE-LAUNCH)

LinkedIn-Led Hype Campaign

5 Hype Wins: 1) UI excellence 2) Authentically Islamic 3) Product speed & suite 4) Referral + Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta 5) Private community forum [MKTG WIN]. 20-30 LI influencers paid.

SEP 2025 — CBUAE LICENSE (EXPECTED)

Regulatory Milestone

If delayed: launch moves to Nov 1 or event to Nov 11.

OCT 10, 2025 — LAUNCH EVENT

Grand Launch

Contingency: Nov 11, 2025 if license delayed past Sep 1.

JUN 2026 — PFM AGENT DEV STARTS

First AI Agent in Development

AI view of all money — 18 markets. Proves "AI-native" positioning.

JUL 2026 — WAVE 1 LAUNCH

USD Banking + PFM Agent (12 products)

USD Account/Payout/Card (Retail + SME) across Pakistan, UAE, Egypt, 18 markets. Invoice Factoring dev starts. SME lending pipeline promotion begins.

AUG 2026 — INVOICE FACTORING LAUNCH

First SME Lending Product

Turn unpaid invoices into working capital. UAE market.

OCT 2026 — WAVE 2 LAUNCH

AED Banking + Lending (12 products)

AED Account/Payout/Card (Retail + SME). Auto Financing, Personal Financing, SME Financing. UAE market.

NOV-DEC 2026 — WAVE 3

IVF, Credit Card, Tuition

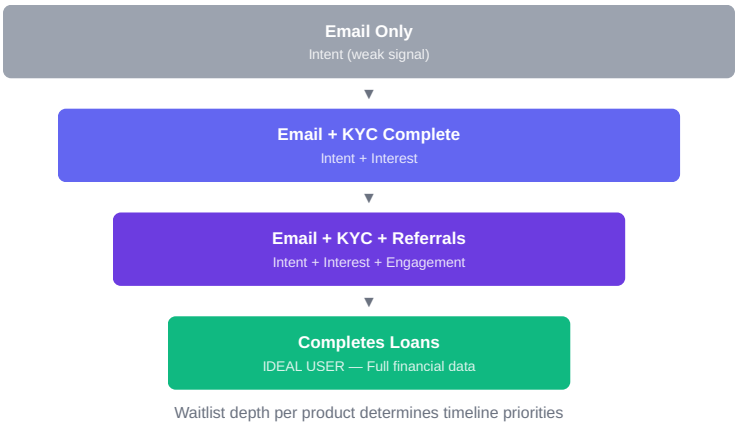
Niche lending products. "Welcome to Dubai" loans, student lending, instant car loans (2 min).

2027 — WAVE 4: AI AGENTS

Travel, Shopping, Tax, CFO, Accounting

Full AI-agent suite. 5 agents across Retail (Travel, Shopping) + SME (Tax, CFO, Accounting).

WAITLIST USER FUNNEL



NEXT 3 MONTHS — SOCIAL FOCUS

- Benchmark against **Revolut** (global), beat **WIO** (local)
- Build roadmap to **1M followers** with timeline
- Define owned media / social web & amplification network
- Map: social PR, influencers, events, outlets
- Study **Brave** marketing approach
- Establish TOV, brand architecture, comms style
- Brand visibility: events, sponsorships, etc.
- Partnership ecosystem: McKinsey papers, amplification

4 INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

SEGMENT	HOOK	INCENTIVE	PRODUCT ANGLE	CHANNEL	KEY MESSAGE
Window Shoppers	"Join waitlist and get paid"	Cash for signup; share on LI/IG/X for \$X free	Waitlist referral virality	Social, Paid LI	Incentive-driven acquisition
Adopters	"Try the tech first"	Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + private community	UI excellence, speed, process quality	LI Thought Leaders	"I have 5 slots to give"
Retail	"Never need SWIFT again"	4x salary on opening; instant car loan (2 min); student loans	New UAE joiners, expats; ACH/USD for EG/TR/IN/PK	Partnerships, Digital	"Welcome to Dubai loan"
SMEs	"Upload paperwork — eligible in seconds"	AED 300K facility at 5%; Mal pays your bills (vendor onboard)	Account + lending one-stop. Bank + Lender vs FAB/WIO/EFG	CFO Summit, Offline (Isham)	"Eligible in seconds"

5 DISTRIBUTION, EVENTS & WAITLIST PLAYBOOK

DISTRIBUTION & PARTNERSHIPS

AREA	STATUS
Sales & marketing framework	NOT ESTABLISHED
Clients ≠ Partners (e.g., ADNOC = client)	PRINCIPLE
Custom approach per design partner	REQUIRED
Pipeline via CFO conf + direct network	IN PROGRESS
McKinsey papers / ecosystem amplify	TO EXPLORE
Offline SME onboarding (Isham)	ASSIGNED

"What is the biggest gap Mal can fill for this design partner?" — each approached in custom format. Aldar = bad example.

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

CFO Summit

- Top CFOs in ME (50 max, private round table)
- 2-3 speakers CFOs want to meet (e.g., Hazem)
- "Where are you facing issues with your existing bank?"
- Capture: company info, employees, distribution channel
- "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"
- Tone: "You are lucky to be a Mal partner"

Media Training Required

Amine David VK Zigor Maen + Walid Youssef Salem

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz | AI: Agents trained on content for internal comms

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

Paid Thought-Leader Strategy

- 10-20 LI thought-leaders (paid)
- Themes: UI, Shariah authenticity, speed, referrals
- Script: "Credit limit in 30 seconds, once licensed they'll kill it"
- CTA: "I have 5 slots to give"
- Referral: Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free
- Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse

4 Hype Pillars

This is what Mal is	Mal looks legit
Positive tech feedback	Speed & process

Rule: Only flex successful experiences. Be quantitative.

6 BRAND ESTABLISHMENT & GUARDRAILS

BRAND DNA & SOCIAL WEB (TO DEFINE)

Brand Foundation ► Tone of Voice (TOV) ► Brand Architecture ► Target Audience (targets, NOT personas) ► Communication Style ► Marketing Assets: decks, attire, gifting ► Internal corporate comms (AI-agents) "We don't believe in personas. We have targets, but serve everyone." Budget 20% split across PR, influencers, events. Minimum dollar spend philosophy.	Owned Media Map ► LinkedIn (primary), IG, X ► 10-20 paid LI thought-leaders ► Events: CFO Summit, Launch, sponsorships ► PR coverage strategy ► McKinsey papers / partnership ecosystem ► Private community (beta forum)
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GUARDRAILS & PRINCIPLES

RULE	RATIONALE
Do NOT call clients "partners"	Closes doors elsewhere (e.g., ADNOC = client)
No generic claims	"Faster, nicer, cheaper" = noise. Be quantitative
Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE)	CBUAE only cares about UAE. Don't mix comms
No user personas	Targets, not personas. Serve everyone
Every \$ ties to growth metric	Min 20% contribution to growth always
Only flex successful experiences	"You transferred in 2 seconds" not "we're fast"
ACH message = convenience	"You have Mal — never need SWIFT again"
SME target for waitlist: 500K in 2mo	CFO Summit first year: 50 max per room, private

7 IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS

#	OWNER(S)	ACTION	PRIORITY	STATUS
1	AAS + Walid	Draft exact timeline dates — one-pager roadmap and product suite sign-off	URGENT	PENDING
2	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm marketing strategy, roles & incentive strategy	URGENT	PENDING
3	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / Nov 11)	URGENT	PENDING
4	Manar	Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (with Mukund input)	HIGH	PENDING
5	Manar + Walid	Meet Global Accounts team → schedule demos with all product leads	HIGH	PENDING
6	Marketing Team	Define waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)	HIGH	PENDING
7	Marketing Team	Identify 10-20 LI thought-leaders for paid hype campaign	HIGH	PENDING
8	Mukund	Develop growth budget request strategy (currently with Amine)	MEDIUM	PENDING
9	Walid	Draft and document marketing roadmap for team alignment	MEDIUM	PENDING
10	Sama / Amine	Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)	MEDIUM	PENDING

NEXT STEP

AAS + Walid finalize timeline → Team alignment meeting → Execute Phase 2 (Waitlist Hype) → Wave 1 products go live Jul 2026

Prepared for internal leadership review
25 products | 4 launch waves | 18 markets